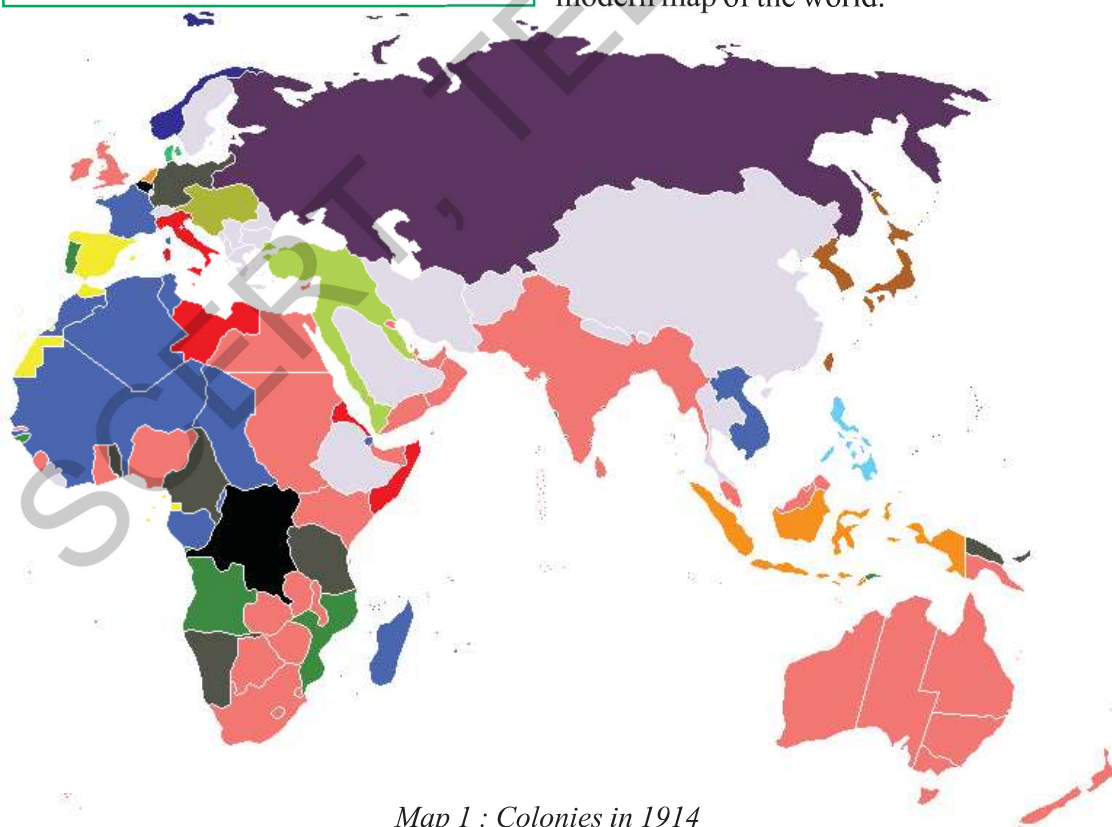




● Identify one Asian and one African colony of Britain.

- Identify one Asian and one African colony of Holland.
- Identify one Asian and one African colony of France.
- Identify two Asian and one African country that was not colony of any power.
- Whose colony was Australia?

Look at the map of colonies given below. In class VIII, you read how European countries controlled over most of Latin American, African and Asian countries by 19th Century. In this chapter, we will read about how these countries fought for freedom. In the map given below, you can see the colonies of Britain in pink colour; the colonies of France in blue; the colonies of Holland in light brown. Some countries of Asia and Africa continued to be independent and these are shown in grey colour. Identify all these countries with the help of a modern map of the world.



Map 1 : Colonies in 1914

Even independent countries like China were actually under the control of many colonial powers and independent only in name. In this chapter, we will read about the difficult situations faced by these colonies and how they began to fight against the domination of the European powers. Most of these countries had different kinds of people who spoke many different languages, or followed different religions. They did not think of themselves as one nation. The traditional rulers in almost all these countries had been kings and emperors. These emperors did not support the ideas of democracy and freedom. As new movements took shape, people in the colonies were inspired by the new ideas from Europe, like nationalism, democracy and even socialism. We will study the experiences of some of these countries and compare them with our own country to how the lives of millions of people of the colonies transformed over time.



- Recall / revisit Class IX textbook as to what constitutes the idea of Nationalism and how it emerged.
- If the traditional rulers of these countries had fought for freedom, what kind of political systems would have been created?
- In colonies, which social groups have fought for freedom? And why were the ideas of equality and democracy important to them?

13.1 China: Two Different Phases

At the beginning of the 20th century, China was ruled by emperors of Manchu dynasty. Manchu dynasty was unsuccessful in defending the interests of China from the western colonial powers. These powers had become very powerful and influential in different parts of China. They had also forced the Chinese emperors to give them economic and political concessions like low import taxes, immunity from Chinese laws, maintaining armed forces, etc. The common people as well as the administrators of the empire were unhappy with this. The administrators tried to reform the systems. The people also revolted against the domination of the western powers.

13.1.1 Establishing the Republic

The Manchu empire was overthrown in 1911 and a republic was established under Sun-Yat-Sen (1866-1925). Yat-Sen is regarded as the founder of modern China. He came from a poor family and studied in missionary schools where he was introduced to democracy and Christianity. He studied medicine but he was greatly concerned about the fate of China. He studied the problems of China and designed a programme of action. His programme was called the Three Principles (*San min chui*). These principles were: “nationalism” – this meant overthrowing the Manchu dynasty, which was seen as a foreign dynasty, as well as other western imperialists; “democracy” or establishing democratic government; and “socialism” which meant controlling industries and land reforms to distribute land to the landless peasants. Even after the Manchu dynasty was overthrown and a republic was declared, the republican government led by Sun-Yat-Sen was unable to come to power. The country was soon controlled by regional military powers called “war lords”.



Fig 13.1 : People protesting in May fourth movement

The social and political situation continued to be unstable in China. On 4th May 1919, people demonstrated in Beijing to protest against the decisions of the Versailles peace conference. Even though China was an ally of the victorious side led by Britain in the world war, it did not get back the territories taken away by Japan. This protest turned into a movement, called the “May Fourth Movement”. A whole generation of people came together to attack the old traditions and to save China through modern

science, democracy and nationalism. Revolutionaries wanted the foreigners to leave China because they were controlling the country’s resources. They also wanted to remove inequalities and reduce poverty from the Chinese society. They advocated many changes in society such as use of simple language and script, abolishing the



- Why do you think young Chinese wanted to fight both against old traditional practices and against foreign powers?
- Did something similar happen in India?

subordination of women and the practice of foot-binding (a cruel practice of not allowing women to have fully grown feet). They also demanded for equality in marriage, and economic development to end poverty.

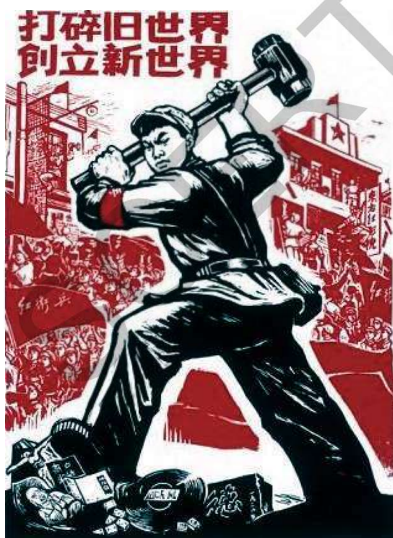


Fig 13. 2 : Poster from a later period saying “Destroy the old world, build a new world.”

After the republican revolution, the country entered a period of great disturbance. The Guomindang (the National People’s Party also called as Kuo-Min-Tang (KMT) and the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) emerged as two major parties. Both the parties wanted to unite the country and bring stability. The Kuo-Min-Tang followed the political philosophy based on Sun Yat-sen’s ideas. They identified the ‘four great needs’ as clothing, food, housing and transportation. After the death of Sun, Chiang-Kai-Shek (1887-1975) emerged as the leader of the Guomindang. He launched a military campaign in China to control the ‘warlords’ and to eliminate the communists. Warlords were regional leaders who had forcefully taken control and authority. Chiang also wanted to militarise the nation. He said that the people must develop a ‘habit and instinct for unified behaviour’.

The Guomindang's (KMT) social base was in urban areas of China. Industrial growth was slow and limited at that time. By 1919, an industrial working class of around 5, 00,000 people had appeared in cities like Shanghai. These cities later became the centre of modern growth. However, only a small percentage of these people were employed in modern industries such as ship building. Most were 'petty urbanites' (*xiao shimin*), traders and shopkeepers. Urban workers, particularly women, earned very low wages. They were now organising themselves into trade unions. Working hours were long and conditions of work were bad. As ideas of freedom became popular, there was a growing concern with women's rights, ways to build a family based on equality and discussions about love and romance. Many schools and universities came up to help in the social and cultural change (Peking University was established in 1902). Journalism also started reflecting the growing attraction of this new thinking.

Chiang was a conservative and he encouraged women to have the four virtues of 'chastity, appearance, speech and work'. He thought that women's roles should be limited to the household. Even the length of hemlines worn by women (frock like dress for women) was prescribed. He also tried to suppress the trade union movements to encourage factory owners. The Guomindang, despite its attempts to unite the country, failed because of its narrow social base and limited political vision. A major plan in Sun Yat-sen's programme was to control the capital and equalise land. But this was never carried out because the party ignored the peasantry and the rising social inequalities. It only tried to impose military orders rather than addressing the problems faced by the people.



What were the major political parties that emerged during the period?

- Who were the members of such mobilisation?
- What was the nature of the social and economic changes that were thought of?

13.1.2 The Rise of the Communist Party of China

When the Japanese invaded China in 1937, the Guomindang withdrew themselves. The long and exhausting war had made China weak. Between 1945 and 1949, prices rose 30 per cent per month. All this had completely destroyed the lives of ordinary people. Rural China faced two crises: one ecological, with soil exhaustion, deforestation and floods, and the second, a socio-economic one caused by exploitation through land-tenure systems, indebtedness, primitive technology and poor communications.

The CCP had been founded in 1921, soon after the Russian Revolution. The success of the Russian revolution had a powerful influence around the world. Leaders such as Lenin established the Comintern in March 1918 to help bring together a world government that would end exploitation. The Comintern and the Soviet Union supported communist parties around the world. But they followed the traditional Marxist idea that only the working class in the cities could bring a revolution.



Fig 13.3 : Mao addressing people in Yanan, 1944

Mao Zedong (1893-1976) emerged as a major CCP leader. He took a different path by basing his revolutionary programme on the peasantry. He organised the Chinese peasants to fight for abolition of landlordism. He also built an army of peasants. Millions of landless peasants joined the struggle led by CCP. His success made the CCP a powerful political party. It ultimately won against the Guomindang. Mao Zedong's radical approach can be seen in Jiangxi, in the mountains, where they camped from

1928 to 1934, secure from Guomindang attacks. A strong peasants' council (soviet) was organised. This council united through confiscation and redistribution of land of landlords. Mao, unlike other leaders, stressed the need for an independent government and army. He had become aware of women's problems and supported the emergence of rural women's associations. He also promoted a new marriage law that forbade arranged marriages, stopped purchase or sale of marriage contracts and simplified divorce.

The Communists' Soviet party was forced to find another base for themselves because of the Guomindang blockade. They went on a Long March (1934-35) which was a gruelling and difficult journey of 6,000 miles to Shanxi. They set up their new base in Yanan. Here, they further developed their programme to end warlordism, carry out land reforms and fight foreign imperialism. This twin agenda of land reform and nationalisation made them successful and made a strong social base for them.

Japan attacked and occupied much of China between 1937 and 1945. They tried to impose a cruel colonial military rule over China. This had a disastrous impact on the Chinese society and economy. Both Guomindang and CCP now tried to join together to fight Japanese occupation. After the surrender of Japan to the US in August 1945, Guomindang and CCP fought a war for control over China. Eventually, CCP was successful in establishing its rule over mainland China while Guomindang was forced to set up its government on the island of Taiwan.

13.1.3 Establishing the New Democracy: 1949-1954

The Peoples Republic of China government was established in 1949. It was based on the principles of the 'New Democracy'. This new principle was an association of all social classes who were opposed to landlordism and imperialism. Important areas of the economy were put under government control. Once in power, the CCP started large scale land reform measures.

They took away the land of landlords and distributing them among poor peasants. The new government also managed to enact laws to protect women, their rights and abolition of polygamy. This enabled women to assume new roles and enjoy equal status vis a vis men in various fields.

13.1.4 Land Reforms

Land reform was launched in 1950-51 after two years of relatively peaceful attempts to understand rural situation and forming peasant associations etc. The major steps were: a class identification of all the people living in the villages, followed by the confiscation and redistribution of landlord land and other productive property. Work teams that were dispatched by county-level land reform committees played a leading role in the process. One of their main functions was to set up peasant associations and select activists from them for local leadership positions. This new leadership was mostly from the poor peasants and middle peasants. In many areas, middle peasants were able to dominate because they were more skilled. In addition, the work teams mobilised the villages against the landlords through mass meetings and trials.



Fig 13.4: People burning land records

The landlords were made to face public humiliation. A large number of members of this class were also executed in these trials, perhaps 10 to 20 lakh individuals.

As an economic reform program, about 43 percent of China's cultivated land was successfully redistributed to about 60 percent of the rural population. Even though the holdings of poor peasants substantially increased, the middle peasants actually benefited the most from land reform because of their stronger initial position.

The old elite had to lose its economic assets and power while a new elite class of village people emerged from poor and middle classes. These people had been brought into political work by the CCP.

Along with the land reforms, another big effort was the setting up of adult peasant schools to spread literacy and political education. Along with this, primary schools were set up for both young children and adults in all the villages.

Most scholars agree that the success of the land reforms and universalisation of education in the initial years of the revolution formed a solid basis for future development of China.



In what ways did the land reform programmes help CCP to win the war?

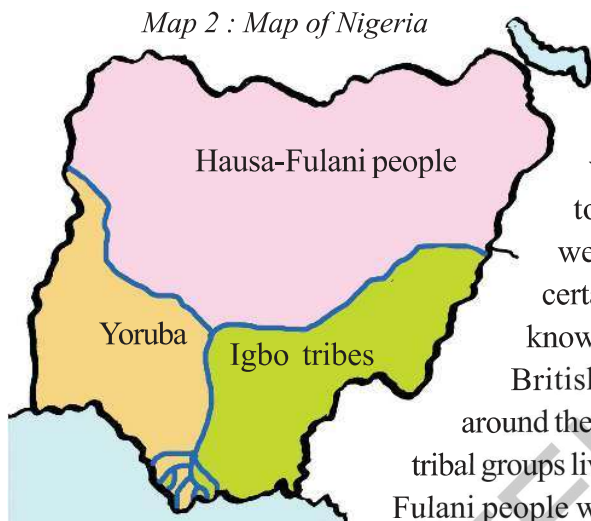
- Compare the land reforms carried out in China with that of India. What were the similarities and differences between them?
- Do you agree with the view that equal participation of men and women and equal opportunity for them is necessary for freedom and development of the country?

The CCP rule gradually established a single party rule in which the supreme leaders or “Chairman” was all powerful. All opposition activities were disallowed.

13.2 Nigeria: Forming Unity against the Colonisers

We now turn to colonialism and nationalism in Africa and study Nigeria on the west coast. Locate this country on a map. Recall what you had read about this country in class VII.

13.2.1 British Colonialism and the Making of a Nation



The idea of nation states was new to the countries of Africa like the rest of the world. The people in Africa were united together through their tribal identity. The western colonisers randomly brought together certain areas under their control. The country we know as Nigeria today was actually created by the British by bringing together different regions around the Niger river system where people of different tribal groups lived. Northern Nigeria is dominated by Hausa-Fulani people who are predominantly Muslims. The South

Eastern part of Nigeria is dominated by Igbo (pronounced as *eebo*) tribes while the South Western portions are dominated by Yoruba tribes. While the people in southern areas are mostly Christians due to long years of missionary activity, many people still practice tribal religious beliefs. Before a common democratic political system was built, modern Nigeria faced many conflicts between these three regions. Today also, the legacy of colonialism continues in Nigeria because of European control over its natural resources, especially petroleum.

The region of river Niger is one of the most densely populated countries of Africa. This region has suffered from different kinds of colonial rule. From the 16th century onwards, it was a major source of slaves for America. Tribal peasants were captured in the interior of the forests and sold to European slave traders. After slave trade was abolished in 19th century, a new interest developed for colonial powers in the trade of the agricultural produce of this area, especially palm oil and cocoa. The British established their rule over the coastal areas in 1861. They developed Lagos as their centre of administration, trade and education in Western Africa. The struggle against colonialism also started in Lagos and Pan Africanism and Nigerian Nationalism emerged here.

Racism became common in the British colonial empire in late 19th and early 20th centuries. Educated Africans were excluded from the civil service, and there was discrimination against African entrepreneurs. At the same time, the authorities from ruling country gave control to the tribal chiefs and elite and promoted them.

South Nigeria got access to modern education and administrative modernisation but pre-modern traditions continued in the north. Because of this, many differences came up between the two regions. The north was not able to develop a modern educated social class. In 1939, the British also separated the Yoruba and Igbo regions into Western and Eastern Nigeria and encouraged competition and conflict between the three major tribal groups. They followed the policy of ‘divide and rule’ in the country.

A section of western educated intellectuals responded to this policy. They developed the idea of a common Nigerian nation and began to fight the British rule. Herbert Macaulay founded the Nigerian National Democratic Party (NNDP), the first Nigerian political party, in 1923. The NNDP won all the seats in the elections of 1923, 1928 and 1933. In the 1930s, Macaulay also supported militant attacks on the British colonial government. In 1936, the Nigerian Youth Movement (NYM) was founded by Nnamdi Azikiwe. NYM appealed to all Nigerians regardless of cultural background. It quickly grew into a powerful political movement. In 1944, Macaulay and NYM leader Azikiwe agreed to form the National Council of Nigeria and the Cameroons (NCNC). Azikiwe became the dominant Nigerian nationalist leader. He also supported pan-Africanism and a pan-Nigerian based nationalist movement.

Nigerian nationalism grew in popularity and power in the post-World War II period as Nigerian economy faced difficult times.

	Pan Africanism
	Pan Africanism is an idea which promotes the unity of all African peoples irrespective of country or tribe. This unity would help not only to fight colonialism and racial discrimination, but also to build unity among tribes and communities living on the continent based on principles of equality, social justice and human dignity. One key person in this regard was Kwame Nkrumah, a freedom fighter from Ghana.



Fig 13.5 : Nnamdi Azikiwe

Nigerian soldiers and the trade union leaders were the backbone of this movement. These soldiers had returned after fighting for the British side in the World War. In 1945, a national general strike was organised by radical nationalist trade unionists.

Nigerian nationalist had the twin task of fighting the British and also unifying the diverse and conflicting ethnic groups of Nigeria. The national movement was stronger in south Nigeria which was more developed as compared to the north. This created a north-south divide between the two regions. Even in the south, there



- Discuss how you think the idea of pan-Africanism is different from nationalism. Do you think the idea of nationalism is limiting?
- Colonial rule led to uneven development of regions in a country. In India too, coastal regions like Bengal, Madras and Bombay developed faster under the British. Why do

were ethnic conflict between the Yoruba and the Igbos. By the 1950s, these three regions also had their own anti-colonial movements led by regional parties: the conservative Northern People's Congress (NPC) in the north; the National Council for Nigeria and the Cameroons (NCNC)

in the east, and the Action Group (AG) in the west.

13.2.2 Independence and weak democracy

After the wave of nationalism in Nigeria, the British decided to hand over power to the Nigerians. They made a complex federal system which made the three major regions of Nigeria autonomous. Nigeria became independent on 1st October, 1960. Unfortunately, a just and democratic balance could not happen. Soon civil war started in Nigeria. Military rule started soon and reinforced the domination of the north.



Fig 13.6 : Bifarian war

People made many attempts to bring in civilian and democratic governments but these failed again and again. The military regime and multinational Oil corporations which funded the corrupt rulers worked together. They spread corruption and suppression of human rights in Nigeria.

After a long period of military dictatorship, Nigerians elected a democratic government in 1999.

It remains to be seen how it faces the challenges of building a democratic Nigeria.

13.2.3 Oil, environment and politics

Oil was discovered in the Niger Delta in 1950s and soon various multinational companies headed by the Dutch Shell company got the rights for oil drilling. Today, it is the most important natural resource of Nigeria. Most of the oil wells are owned by these corporations which extract Nigerian oil and share part of its profits with the military rulers. But the common people get very little benefit from this. In addition, the coastal environment of Nigeria has been disturbed because of reckless oil extraction by foreign oil companies. Oil spillage from oil wells has a major impact on the ecosystem. Large areas of the mangrove forests, which are especially susceptible to oil, have been destroyed. This is mainly because oil is stored in the soil and re-released annually. Around 5–10% of Nigerian mangrove ecosystems have been destroyed either by clearing or oil. Spills destroy crops and aquaculture through contamination of the groundwater and soil. Drinking water is also frequently contaminated, and sheen of oil is visible in many local bodies of water. Even if there is no immediate health effect of this water contamination, it can cause cancer in the long term. Offshore spills, which are usually much bigger in scale, contaminate the coastal environments and cause a decline in the local fish production.



Fig 13.7 : Oil Spill



Fig 13.8 : Ken Saro

Throughout the early 1990s, there was growing unrest, particularly in the Niger Delta region. The various ethnic groups began demanding compensation for the ecological damage that has been happening for many years as well as control over their land's oil resources. This unrest initially started as peaceful activist organisations that united their members on the basis of ethnicity.



Most of the oil resources of Nigeria are in the South Eastern region. The Igbos think that they should get the maximum share of oil profits. They object to oil wealth being used for development of the North. What do you think will be the proper and just solution to this problem?

However, in 1990 an eminent human rights activist and environmentalist Ken Saro Wiwa was executed by the military government despite international protests. Since then the situation has been tense.

Thus you can see that Nigeria is still making efforts to come together as a nation, work out a stable democratic system and gain control over its material resources.

 Key words		
1. Land reforms	2. Landlordism	3. New Democracy
4. Chemical arms	5. Forced labour	6. Pan - Africanism

 Improve your learning		 E5Q7Z3
1. Match the following 1) Sun Yat-sen () a) Militarised the nation 2) Chiang Kaishek () b) Environmental movement 3) Mao Zedong () c) Nationalism Democracy and Socialism 4) Ken Saro Wiwa () d) Peasant revolution		
2. Trace the changes in the role of women seen in China over the decades. Why is it similar or different from that of USSR and Germany?		
3. After the overthrow of monarchy, China had two different types of regimes. How were they similar or different?		
4. Countries discussed in the chapter were all mostly dependent on agriculture. What were the measures taken in these countries to change these practices?		
5. Who owned industries in countries discussed above and what policies were brought in to change the systems? Make a table to compare them.		
6. Compare the national movement in India and Nigeria - can you explain why it was stronger in India?		
7. What are the challenges faced by the independent Nigerian nation? In what ways is it similar or different from the challenges faced by independent India?		
8. Unlike India, Nigeria did not have to struggle so hard for freedom. Can you find some explanations for this?		
9. Freedom struggle in these countries involved wars against the rulers. Briefly describe its impact.		